

Introduction

In the context of capital theory, the correlation between the arts and socioeconomic status (SES) is a virtuous circle for the upper classes and a pernicious circle for the lower classes. Numerous studies have investigated how art education influences people's SES, but relatively few studies have examined how SES itself influences the chance of a child being exposed to the arts. As a means of filling the research gap in this area, this research will test the hypothesis that people's socioeconomic status influences their arts engagement. If the correlation coefficient falls within the designated range and satisfies the significance level, one-way regression analysis can be used to elucidate and anticipate the impact of SES on arts engagement. This provides valuable insight on the outcomes of the City Beautiful movement (Olsen, 1998). In addition, it can increase awareness and promote art education.

Literature Review

Reid (1926) argues that the wide variety of art forms makes the definition of arts engagement highly ambiguous and variable, which empowers us to inspect it more subjectively. Despite asking specific questions about participation in 28 artistic activities, Wang et al. (2020) still acknowledged the challenge of ensuring the inclusion of all artistic activities. In his discussion of artistic experiences, Wziak-Biaowolska (2016) seeks to differentiate between active participation in the arts (playing instruments, dancing, painting, etc.) and passive participation (watching films, theater, exhibitions, etc.). Nonetheless, when analyzing the results, he continues to refer to them collectively as voluntary cultural activity. This indicates that there is no discernible distinction between the two, at least in

terms of outcomes. According to Novak-Leonard et al. (2015), the discourse surrounding arts engagement is inclined towards Western artistic practices and disregards the broader meaning of the term in ethnic minority and migrant communities (Brown & Cousins, 2001). In this instance, when the phrase "arts engagement" is employed holistically without a comprehensive delineation of the particular activities encompassed, the freedom to interpret the phrase may be ceded to the participants.

The UK has abundant artistic resources; nevertheless, how it reproduces socioeconomic inequality exemplifies the significance of cultural capital. According to statistics given by the Museum Association and Theatres Trust, there are approximately 2,500 museums and 1,100 active theaters in the country. However, it is more essential to note that the top five most-visited attractions that year were all located in London (Association of Leading Visitor Attractions, 2019). The England Arts Council has cited geographical inequality in arts funding as a contributing factor (Mak et al., 2020b). Inequalities are not solely based on geography. Since art has always been an exclusive concept, only a select few have the authority to define it (Grenfell & Hardy, 2007). Discourse on art implies a value, a specific flavor, or a standard (Silva, 2008). Disparities in people's access to artistic resources can be discussed within the theoretical framework of cultural capital. There is a correlation between accumulated cultural knowledge and social status and power (Bourdieu & Passeron, 1977). The key to understanding the significance of cultural capital in practice is to recognize how it is intertwined with privileged life, enabling the emergence of privileged habits and dispositions in packs that cannot be taught individually to other classes (Ostrower, 1998; Reay, 2017). Consistent with Frow and Emmison's (1998) expansion of cultural capital in their discourse on information technology, arts engagement serves as a means of expression and self-presentation, conferring benefits upon individuals who possess expertise and familiarity with the arts. The upper classes have exclusive knowledge that is not available to the lower classes. Meanwhile, this knowledge facilitates the integration of privileged groups into society.

According to earlier studies (Devine & Dowds, 2013; McManus & Furnham, 2006), exposure to artistic resources positively correlates with socioeconomic status, and arts engagement is geographically and socially context-dependent (Mak et al., 2020b). There is a social gradient of interest in artistic activities, as indicated by mixed evidence (Bone et al., 2021). When proposing the concept of capitals, Bourdieu and Passeron (1977) placed special emphasis on the inheritance passed down from one generation to the next. Parents should invest in their children's cultural capital by exposing them to the arts (Kapitzke, 2000). Frow and Emmison (1998) found that families with satisfactory financial situations are more likely to involve their children in artistic activities. Lynch and Kaplan (2000) describe socioeconomic status (SES) as a conceptualization of social and economic stratification. Research suggests that people with greater educational attainment and better employment prospects are more likely to participate in artistic activities than those with lower socioeconomic status (Parkinson et al., 2014; Mak et al., 2020a). Traditional measures of SES in health-related reporting include income, education, and occupation (Adler & Ostrove, 1999). Following Quon and McGrath's (2015) notion of relative SES and emphasis on the significance of evaluating multiple dimensions, the present research introduces subjective SES and the geographical context dimension. Individuals' subjective socioeconomic status (SES) is based on their perception of their position in society, which can be influenced by their comparison to others in their community (Singh-Manoux et al., 2003).

Methodology

Following is the overarching logic of this research. First of all, a correlation between two variables, SES and the proportion of their expenditure spent on arts engagement, should be confirmed. A hypothesis is formulated to establish a functional relationship between the independent and dependent variables. As part of the modeling process, a regression analysis will be conducted to assess the

hypothesis. The correlation coefficient between the two variables is calculated using SPSS. The correlation will only be considered valid if the absolute value of the coefficient is greater than 0.5 and the significance level is less than 0.05. Mak et al. (2020a) recommend a 95% confidence interval for the coefficient to account for interplay between household members and prevent underestimation of the standard error that arises from evaluating SES and arts engagement within the context of the household. Assuming the presence of correlations, one-way regression analysis will be employed to furnish additional comprehensive insights, including forecasting changes in the dependent variable.

Data will be collected through a questionnaire. I will conduct a pilot test and modify the options on the questionnaire based on the results. The population of this research is comprised of non-art undergraduates at UCL who have spent most of their formative years in Europe. The study limits the population to non-arts students in order to regulate their exposure to the arts in everyday learning. Undergraduates are selected for the purpose of controlling for their educational attainment and age. Additionally, the study focuses specifically on UCL to mitigate the influence of school resources on the population. The sampling methodology is stratified sampling based on majors. Moreover, in asking questions like monthly expenditures, a specific month like "March 2023" would be clarified. Although there is a wealth of resources for the arts in London all year round, there are also exhibition cycles when galleries update their displays or highly concentrated seasons for performances, so the survey period needs to be longer than a month to ensure consistency.

The independent variable of the study is the socioeconomic status of the student's family, and the dependent variable is the proportion of arts participation expenditures. Due to the fact that correlation analysis can only be performed on continuous data, the results will be presented as continuous data, which is better suited for statistical testing and modeling purposes. The options for the questions are in ordinal form, however, to ease collection and more accurately reflect the circumstances of

participants. In order to simplify the weighting computation, the data discretization approach is frequently utilized. For instance, convert proportion data into categorical ranks. To explore the relationship between the dependent variable and several independent variables, we will measure the independent variables in five dimensions: income level, education (attainment and grade point average), occupation (category and level), subjective judgment, and the ranking of the city in the Cultural and Creative Cities Monitor (European Cultural Foundation, 2020). We will employ an equal-weighted summation method to derive a continuous value that represents the collective impact of the independent variables. Specifically, calculate the mean value for each dimension, which will serve as the central value. Weights will be assigned to the central values to account for their relative importance in the model. We will assign 10% weight to each of the two values of educational attainment and occupation and 20% weight to income, subjective SES, and the city lived in during formative years. Finally, we will calculate the weighted central values to obtain a continuous dataset that will be used for correlation coefficient and regression analyses. This process will ensure the validity and reliability of the findings.

The relative income index will be calculated by dividing the family's income from the previous year by the national average family income for that year. After that, a scale may be used to convert the continuous variables into ordinal data by having the participants place their calculated results into predetermined categories. For instance, Option A, which ranges from 0% to 25%, would be selected if the calculated value was 18%. The scale is generated according to a pilot, designating each equal portion an ordinal number. The measurement of educational attainment is based on the primary caregiver with whom the participant spent the most time before university. Besides, the grade point average attained at the time of acquiring the aforementioned qualification would be obtained and converted to ordinal data. The occupation of that family member will also be evaluated on two dimensions: the nature and level of the occupation. Both dimensions will be determined using the International Standard Classification of Occupations, which categorizes occupations according to their

level of complexity and level of specialization. Participants will be asked to provide an occupation category and level. Based on the work of Quon and McGrath (2015), we will pose the question, "Do you think your family's SES is better or worse than that of your classmates?" Options, each corresponding to one ordinal data point, will be provided to participants. Besides, inquire about the artistic richness of a growing city as a variable control. Participants will be asked to identify cities that meet certain conditions in the city question. According to the comprehensive ranking in the European Cultural Foundation's Cultural and Creative Cities Monitor (2020), an ordinal figure will be derived.

The study's dependent variable is the proportion of monthly expenditure on arts engagement, obtained by dividing monthly art engagement expenditures by total monthly expenditures and multiplying by 100%. Both interpretation and design problems are complicated by the term arts engagement's flexibility and subjectivity (Novak-Leonard et al., 2015). Thus, participants will be given a list of examples of arts engagement in the form of phrases like "Arts engagement includes but is not limited to..."; however, arts engagement will be viewed as a subjectively interpreted term as a whole.

The most necessary of all ethical safeguards is to ensure that participants are comfortable identifying their SES, which is highly personal and sensitive. It is essential to protect the respondents' information, for example by anonymizing and encrypting it, and to ensure that no hidden damage occurs throughout the survey. Respondents' informed consent should be secured by both the content of the survey and its intended application. Furthermore, discussion should avoid personal bias to maintain the credibility and reliability of the results. In addition, the methodology, data collection, and analysis process should be made public in order to promote transparency and guarantee that the results are used appropriately.

Conclusion

However, it is important to acknowledge that there may be recall bias in the data collection process, as the survey questionnaire relies on self-reporting. In some cases, the participants must subjectively understand and decide which family member to report on. Additionally, the situation of one particular family member may not fully represent the situation of the entire family, such as when a mother with no regular income spends the most time with her child but the grandparents own a profitable company. In terms of data analysis, conversions between continuous and ordinal data can result in data loss and reduce the flexibility of analysis. Due to the many limiting conditions imposed during sampling, it is challenging to generalize the research findings to a larger population. Our research is expected to have a number of notable strengths, providing new insights from two perspectives. Firstly, it can serve as a means for directing and improving the redistribution of artistic resources. Secondly, it aims to investigate the practical application of capital theory. The enduring system of dispositions that is acquired through participating in artistic activities is referred to as "habitus" (Bourdieu, 1987; Navarro, 2006). In the context of the accelerating segregation caused by constantly evolving information technology (Choi et al., 2020), art has become even more exclusive. Therefore, previous results may be outdated and require updating research progress. Moving forward, research in this area should focus on the mutual influence among multiple independent variables or the mutual influence between independent variables and dependent variables. A collective environment composed of people carrying the same social capital makes society increasingly segregated. Expanding the discussion of Bourdieu's (1986) concept of capital reveals that the relationships between variables exceed one-way regression analysis. Bidirectional regression analysis is a promising area for further study.

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